

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 929

By Southerland

A RESOLUTION to honor Herbert "Buddy" Mayes on being inducted into the Boys & Girls Clubs of Tennessee Hall of Fame.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should specially recognize those stalwart citizens who are dedicated to improving the quality of life for the youth in their communities; and

WHEREAS, Herbert "Buddy" Mayes, longtime board member of the Boys & Girls Club of Morristown, is one such outstanding servant-leader; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Mayes has been inducted into the Boys & Girls Clubs of Tennessee Hall of Fame in recognition of his hard work and generosity in support of this worthy organization; and

WHEREAS, Buddy Mayes has proudly served as a board member of the Boys & Girls Club of Morristown for forty-eight years, and he continues to go above and beyond for young people and their families; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Mayes has provided valuable leadership to the Boys & Girls Club of Morristown in numerous roles, including as chief volunteer officer, vice chair of the board, and chair of the president's council/executive committee; and

WHEREAS, he has also been a leading fundraiser, board recruiter, and Club ambassador for the organization throughout his tenure, and he was instrumental in establishing the Club's major fundraising event, the Super Auction, which now raises more than \$125,000 each year for the Club; and

WHEREAS, for more than twenty years, Mr. Mayes and his family provided Christmas gifts for Club members and their families, as well as clothes for children, first cars for families, and resources for students to attend school events and trips; and

WHEREAS, in addition to chaperoning Club events, Mr. Mayes provided jobs for teenagers, helped former Club members start businesses, and assisted numerous Club families with funeral expenses; and

WHEREAS, perhaps one of his proudest accomplishments during his career with the Boys & Girls Club was recruiting Bill Seals as Executive Director in 1980; and

WHEREAS, Buddy Mayes and Bill Seals were able to reach incredible heights, including securing numerous State and National Boys & Girls Club of America program awards and celebrating a National Youth of the Year winner and runner-up; and

WHEREAS, no stranger to awards and accolades, Buddy Mayes was a 1982 recipient of the President's Gavel, the Boys & Girls Club's highest honor; he also received the Man of the Year Award, the Service to Youth Award, and the prestigious Lifetime Achievement Award, most befitting honors that recognize his generosity, his exceptional leadership, and the positive impact he has made on so many young lives; and

WHEREAS, Buddy Mayes earned a degree from the Kentucky School of Mortuary Science in 1969; in 1972, Mr. Mayes and his father purchased Mayes Mortuary, continuing a legacy of compassionate care that has served generations of families; and

WHEREAS, a leader in his profession, Mr. Mayes served as President of the State Board of Funeral Directors and Embalmers, President of the Tennessee Funeral Directors Association, and later as Vice President of Operations for one of the largest providers of funeral, cemetery, and cremation services in North America; and

WHEREAS, Buddy Mayes currently works part-time alongside his daughter at Stubblefield Funeral Home, continuing his service to families in his community; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Mayes has served the broader local community with the same dedication and distinction as a member of the Youth Emergency Shelter Board, the Kingswood Home for Children Board, the Morristown Jaycees, and the Rotary Club of Morristown; and

WHEREAS, his many professional accomplishments aside, Mr. Mayes enjoyed many years of love and companionship with his cherished wife, Donna Tinnell Mayes, until her passing; and

WHEREAS, together, Mr. and Mrs. Mayes formed a lifelong partnership rooted in faith, family, and service and raised three children: Terri, Tracy, and Tyler; Mr. Mayes is the proud grandfather of several grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, Buddy Mayes is wholly committed to the noble precepts of youth empowerment that have earned Tennessee recognition as the Volunteer State, and it is appropriate that he should be specially recognized on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Herbert "Buddy" Mayes on being inducted into the Boys & Girls Clubs of Tennessee Hall of Fame and thank him for his ongoing commitment to his community and the youth of Tennessee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.